

PAX: Portable Audit eXporter

Unlocking Copilot ROI through intelligent audit data automation

THE CHALLENGE

Microsoft 365 Copilot customers are investing millions—but most struggle to demonstrate tangible ROI. The key lies in usage data buried deep inside Microsoft Purview audit logs. Purview was built for compliance, not analytics, and its extraction limits make large-scale reporting nearly impossible.

Even sophisticated enterprise IT teams run into barriers:

- Audit log extractions fail when activity exceeds the 1M record limit.
- Manual PowerShell scripts require constant babysitting and produce incomplete results.
- Analysts spend days stitching together fragmented exports.

The result: weeks after deployment, leadership is still asking, 'Is anyone actually using Copilot, and is it driving value?'

THE PAX SOLUTION

PAX (Portable Audit eXporter) turns Microsoft Purview from a technical obstacle into a strategic data source. A single PowerShell script intelligently automates audit log extraction, ensuring complete, Power BI-ready data.

Key Capabilities:

- Intelligent automation: Dynamically adjusts extraction windows to avoid Purview limits.
- Complete data capture: Detects and re-processes dense periods automatically.
- Power BI-ready output: Delivers clean, structured data for immediate analysis.
- Lightweight and portable: Runs anywhere—no installation, no dependencies.
- Schedule and forget: Easily integrates into Azure Automation or Windows Task Scheduler.

Within hours, customers can produce enterprise-wide visibility into Copilot adoption and usage.

WHY IT MATTERS

PAX addresses one of the largest blockers to understanding Copilot value: data accessibility. By automating the extraction process and structuring the output for analytics, PAX enables:

- ROI Visibility: Leadership gains measurable insights into Copilot adoption and business impact.
- Operational Efficiency: IT teams eliminate manual data wrangling.
- Faster Insights: Power BI dashboards update automatically, reducing time-to-clarity from weeks to hours.
- Scalability: Works seamlessly across tenants of any size.

- Extensibility: Built to expand beyond Purview to Entra, Graph, Viva Insights, and Dynamics 365.

EARLY IMPACT & TRAJECTORY

The Copilot ROI Analysis team has initiated pilots with enterprise customers to validate PAX's scalability and automation performance. Early findings confirm:

- Successful extraction of multi-million record sets without data loss.
- Immediate integration with Copilot usage dashboards.
- Significant time savings for IT and analytics teams.

This early success validates PAX as the foundation for a unified audit analytics framework across Microsoft 365 workloads.

THE ROAD AHEAD

PAX begins with Purview but is designed for expansion. Future modules will bring the same intelligence to additional Microsoft data sources:

- Entra ID: Authentication and security analytics.
- Microsoft Graph: Collaboration and engagement patterns.
- Viva Insights: Productivity and wellbeing metrics.
- Dynamics 365: Customer engagement and CRM data.

Together, these will form a consistent, automated foundation for Copilot ROI measurement across the Microsoft ecosystem.

AVAILABILITY

Repository: github.com/microsoft/PAX

Maintained by: Copilot ROI Analysis Team, Copilot Growth & Incubation

Audience: Enterprise customers adopting Microsoft 365 Copilot

Status: Pilot phase with enterprise customers

SUMMARY

PAX exemplifies how Microsoft's Copilot ROI Analysis team transforms technical complexity into customer clarity. It enables customers—and Microsoft's own field teams—to measure adoption, demonstrate ROI, and make data-driven Copilot decisions.

In short: PAX takes something hard, makes it simple, and turns compliance data into business intelligence.